

Consider that Pacman is in a world with three states X , Y , and Z . There are two possible actions from each state P and Q . Assume $\gamma = 1$, $\alpha = 0.5$, and the initial Q -values are 0 for all state.

1. We get the following samples generated from taking actions sequentially in this world:

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(CO3)
(PO3)

S	A	S'	R
X	Q	Y	2
Y	Q	Z	-6
Z	P	X	0
X	P	Y	-2
Y	P	Z	-2
Z	Q	X	2

With detailed steps, recommend the optimal policy after considering the samples.

Solution:

For $(X, Q, Y, 2)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} Q(X, Q) &= (1 - \alpha)Q(X, Q) + \alpha \left(r + \gamma \max_A Q(Y, A) \right) \\ &= (1 - 0.5) \times 0 + 0.5 \times (2 + 1 \times 0) \\ &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

For $(Y, Q, Z, -6)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} Q(Y, Q) &= (1 - \alpha)Q(Y, Q) + \alpha \left(r + \gamma \max_A Q(Z, A) \right) \\ &= (1 - 0.5) \times 0 + 0.5 \times (-6 + 1 \times 0) \\ &= -3 \end{aligned}$$

For $(Z, P, X, 0)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} Q(Z, P) &= (1 - \alpha)Q(Z, P) + \alpha \left(r + \gamma \max_A Q(X, A) \right) \\ &= (1 - 0.5) \times 0 + 0.5 \times (0 + 1 \times 1) \\ &= 0.5 \end{aligned}$$

For $(X, P, Y, -2)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} Q(X, P) &= (1 - \alpha)Q(X, P) + \alpha \left(r + \gamma \max_A Q(Y, A) \right) \\ &= (1 - 0.5) \times 0 + 0.5 \times (-2 + 1 \times 0) \\ &= -1 \end{aligned}$$

For $(Y, P, Z, -2)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} Q(Y, P) &= (1 - \alpha)Q(Y, P) + \alpha \left(r + \gamma \max_A Q(Z, A) \right) \\ &= (1 - 0.5) \times 0 + 0.5 \times (-2 + 1 \times 0.5) \\ &= -0.75 \end{aligned}$$

For $(Z, Q, X, 2)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} Q(Z, Q) &= (1 - \alpha)Q(Z, Q) + \alpha \left(r + \gamma \max_A Q(X, A) \right) \\ &= (1 - 0.5) \times 0 + 0.5 \times (2 + 1 \times 1) \\ &= 1.5 \end{aligned}$$

So the optimal actions for each state are:

$$\begin{aligned} \pi(X) &= \operatorname{argmax} (Q(X, Q), Q(X, P)) = Q \\ \pi(Y) &= \operatorname{argmax} (Q(Y, Q), Q(Y, P)) = P \\ \pi(Z) &= \operatorname{argmax} (Q(Z, Q), Q(Z, P)) = Q \end{aligned}$$

Rubric:

- 1 point per iteration
- 1 point per optimal action

2. Assume that after the previous steps, we decide to utilize two features:

$$f_1(s, a) = 1$$

$$f_2(s, a) = \begin{cases} 1 & a = P \\ -1 & a = Q \end{cases}$$

to calculate the value of a state and the initial weights $w_1 = w_2 = 1$. The initial Q-values are the once determined in Question 1. We observe the following samples:

S	A	S'	R
X	P	Y	4
Y	Q	X	0

With detailed steps, recommend the optimal policy after considering the samples.

Solution:

For $(X, P, Y, 4)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{Q}(X, P) &= w_1 f_1(X, P) + w_2 f_2(X, P) \\ &= 1 \times 1 + 1 \times 1 \\ &= 2 \\ \text{diff} &= \left[r + \max_A Q(Y, A) \right] - \hat{Q}(X, P) \\ &= 4 - 0.75 - 2 \\ &= 1.25 \\ w_1 &= w_1 + \alpha [\text{diff}] f_1 \\ &= 1 + 0.5 \times 1.25 \times 1 \\ &= 1.625 \\ w_2 &= w_2 + \alpha [\text{diff}] f_2 \\ &= 1 + 0.5 \times 1.25 \times 1 \\ &= 1.625\end{aligned}$$

For $(Y, Q, X, 0)$, we get:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{Q}(Y, Q) &= 1.625 \times 1 + 1.625 \times (-1) \\ &= 0 \\ \text{diff} &= \left[r + \max_A Q(X, A) \right] - \hat{Q}(Y, Q) \\ &= 0 + 1 - 0 \\ &= 1 \\ w_1 &= w_1 + \alpha [\text{diff}] f_1 \\ &= 1.625 + 0.5 \times 1 \times 1 \\ &= 2.125 \\ w_2 &= w_2 + \alpha [\text{diff}] f_2 \\ &= 1.625 + 0.5 \times 1 \times (-1) \\ &= 1.125\end{aligned}$$

The Q-values are:

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{Q}(X, P) &= w_1 f_1(X, P) + w_2 f_2(X, P) \\ &= 2.125 \times 1 + 1.125 \times 1 \\ &= 3.25\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{Q}(X, Q) &= w_1 f_1(X, P) + w_2 f_2(X, Q) \\ &= 2.125 \times 1 + 1.125 \times (-1) \\ &= 1\end{aligned}$$

Note that, the features do not depend on the states, so the Q-values will be the same for all three. We get:

$$\pi(X) = \pi(Y) = \pi(Z) = \operatorname{argmax}(Q(X, P), Q(X, Q)) = P$$

Rubric:

- 1 point per update
- 1 point for Q-values
- 1 point per optimal policy